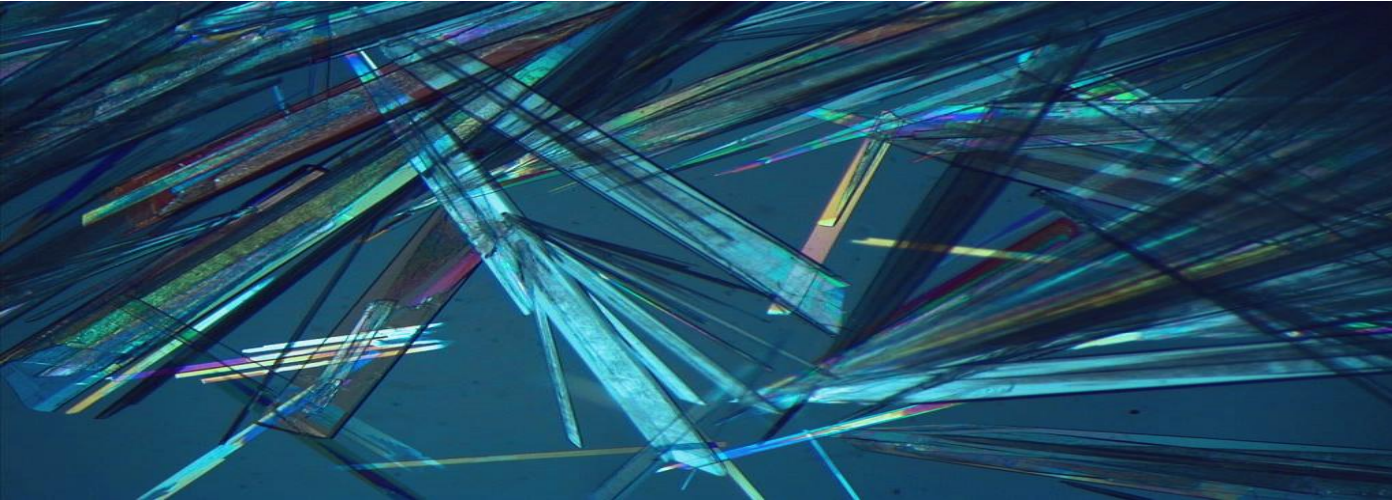




Advanced Materials (AdMat) in Crystal Engineering

- What is Crystal Engineering and why do we study it?
- Background and basics
- Intermolecular Interactions
- Crystal design principles
- Polymorphs
- Multi-component crystals
- Structure-property relation
- Functional materials and their properties
- Concepts and strategies to develop new materials
- Boundaries

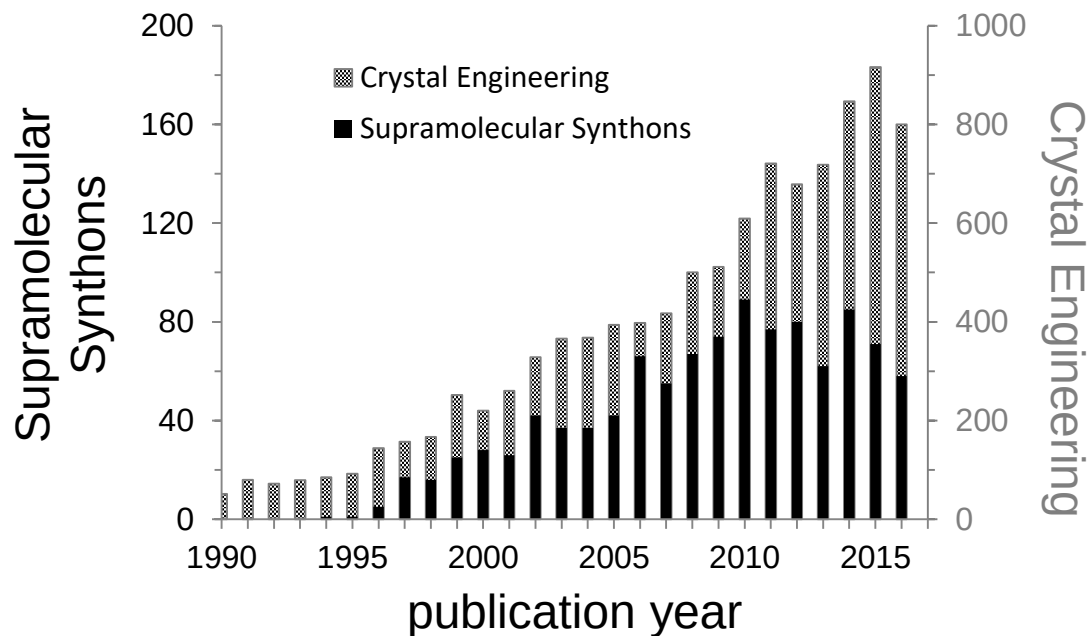
Goals:

- ✓ Understanding of CE principles
- ✓ Critical assessment of possibilities & perspectives
- ✓ Structural design to function transfer
- ✓ Realistic overview of the potential for developing functional materials

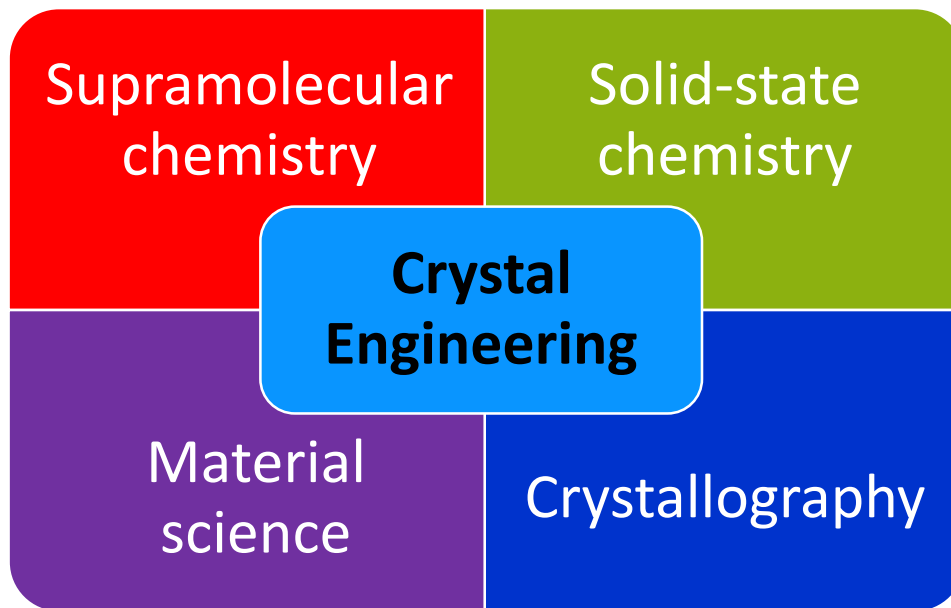
- G. R. Desiraju, J. J. Vittal, A. Ramanan, Crystal Engineering: A Textbook, 2011, World Scientific Publishing,
- E. R. T. Tiekink, J. J. Vittal, M. J. Zaorotko (Eds.), Organic Crystal Engineering. Frontiers in crystal engineering, 2010, Wiley Publishing
- J. Bernstein, Polymorphism in Molecular Crystals, 2008 International Union of Crystallography, Oxford Press
- E. R. T. Tiekink, J. Zukerman-Schpector (Eds.), Multi-component crystals. Synthesis, concepts, function, 2018 De Gruyter
- Scientific publications (online search: Google Scholar, SciFinder Database, Scopus and Web of Science)
- **ILIAS:** AdMat-CE group
- CSD-Database (Cambridge Structural Database): Web CSD with HHU license
 - >> registration with HHU email > download Mercury or full package (10 GB)
 - Site/Customer Number: 531
 - Licence Key: D9A73E-B5F993-4C1196-B4B3BE-2E256C-F4084F
- Mercury Software from CCDC (Cambridge Crystallographic Data Centre) <https://www.ccdc.cam.ac.uk/>

Crystal Engineering: young field with many perspectives

A survey of articles on the topic of CE from 1990 to 2016



Is CE Inorganic Chemistry?



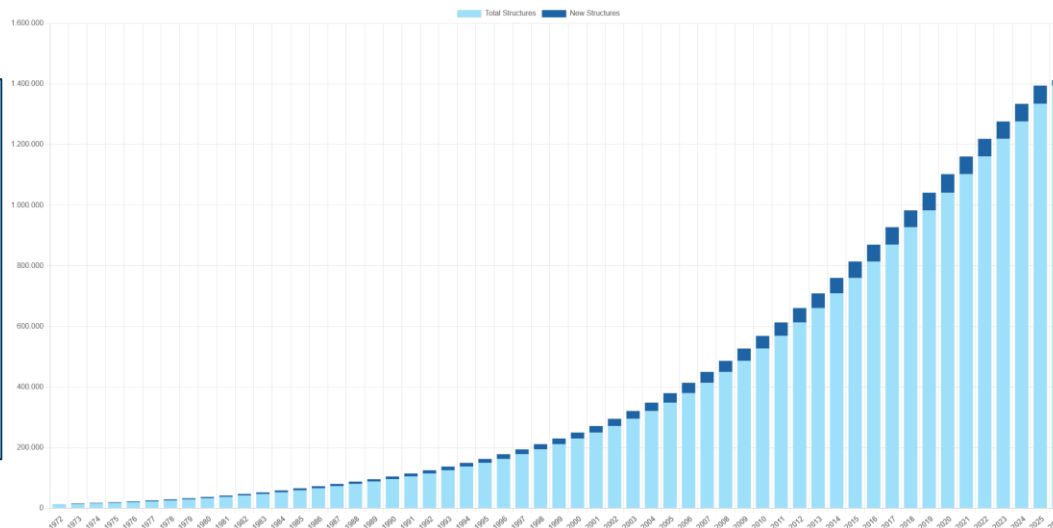
CSD growth

resulted in a rapid growth Crystal Engineering field

CSD 1972 to 2026

$\Delta \sim 55.000 - 65.000$ entries per year

	
Number of Curated Entries in CSD 1,454,146	Unique Curated Structures in CSD 1,412,578
	
CSD Communications 75,366	Number of Refcode Families 1,292,982



June 2026

1.454.146 entries

2025

~ 1.394.800 entries

2024

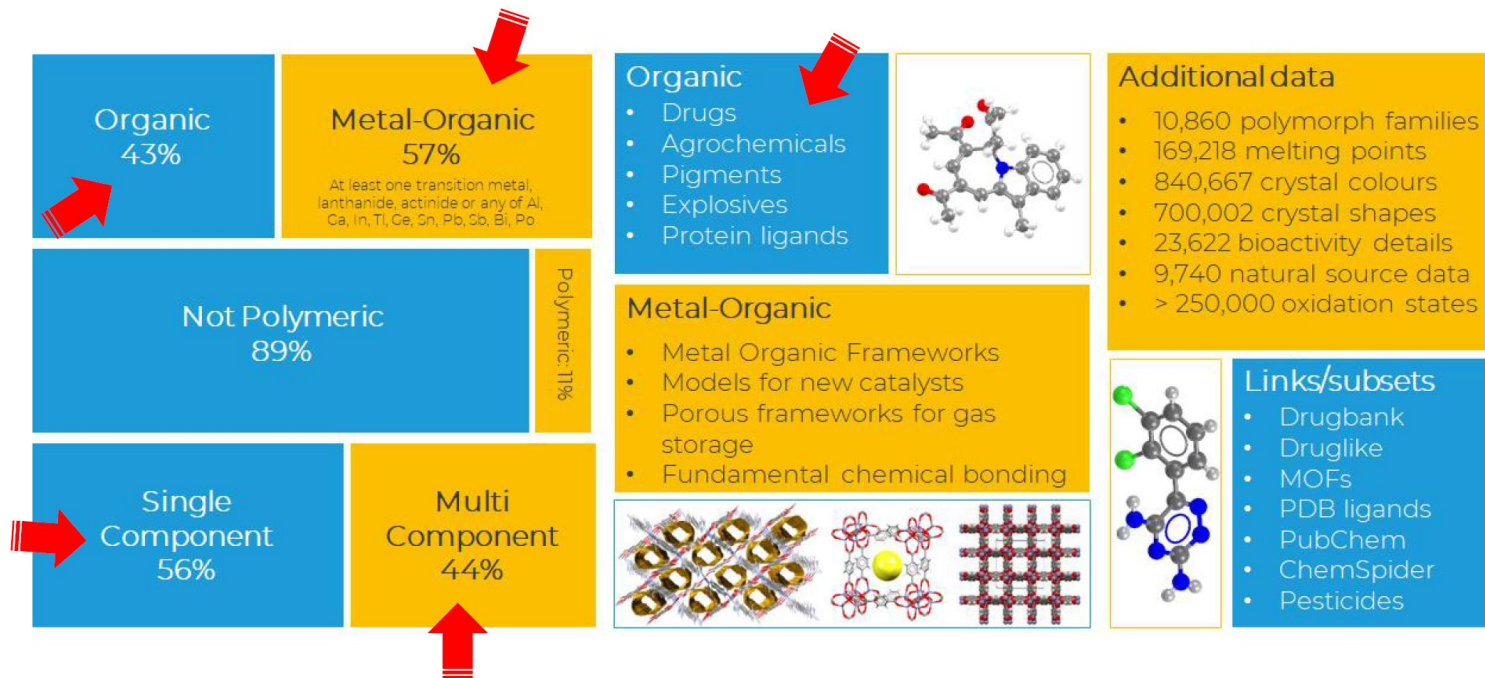
~ 1.334.700 entries

2023

~ 1.276.400 entries

2020 - 1 mln entries

What's in the CSD?



Where everything begun?... Supramolecular chemistry

Molecule – focus of **classical chemistry**

- ultimate delimiter of all significant **properties of a substance**.
- only structures and functions involving **covalent bond**

BUT: some biological systems/phenomena do not involve making or breaking chemical bonds.

INSTEAD: bio systems are usually formed of loose aggregates held together by **non-covalent interactions**

FURTHER: Some fundamental properties cannot be explained by molecular structure.

Molecular recognition

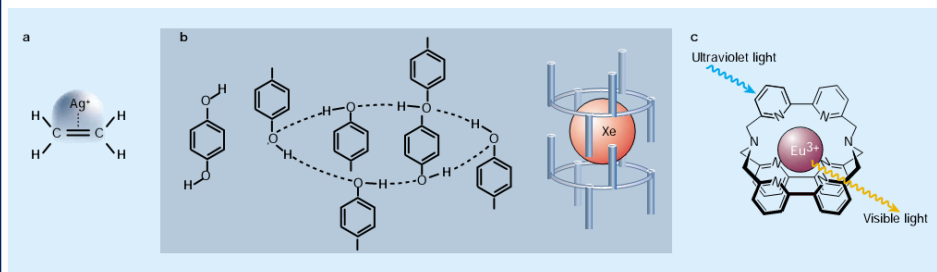
- lock-and-key model
- enzyme-substrate interaction (E. Fischer 1894)
- molecules recognise one another through their dissimilarities rather than through their similarities

Supramolecular function

- highly specific interactions lead to useful supramolecular functions

⇒ Interest - stable compounds that do not involve covalent bonds

Chemistry beyond the molecule



G. Desiraju, *Nature*, (2001), 412, 397.

Supramolecular chemistry is a chemistry of the intermolecular bond

J.-M. Lehn, 1969

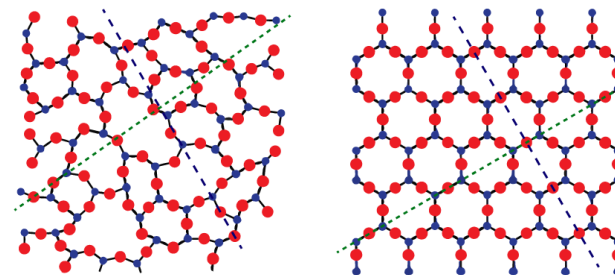
Crystal Engineering (CE) –

understanding of intermolecular interactions in the context of crystal packing

Aim: design of new solid materials with desired chemical and physical properties

Crystal is an ordered and periodic arrangement of molecules/atoms

design of solids with desired properties $\leftrightarrow$ means design crystals where molecule are organised in certain ways.



What do we do?

→ make crystals by using interactions

How do we do it?

→ synthetic strategies

Why do we do it?

→ properties

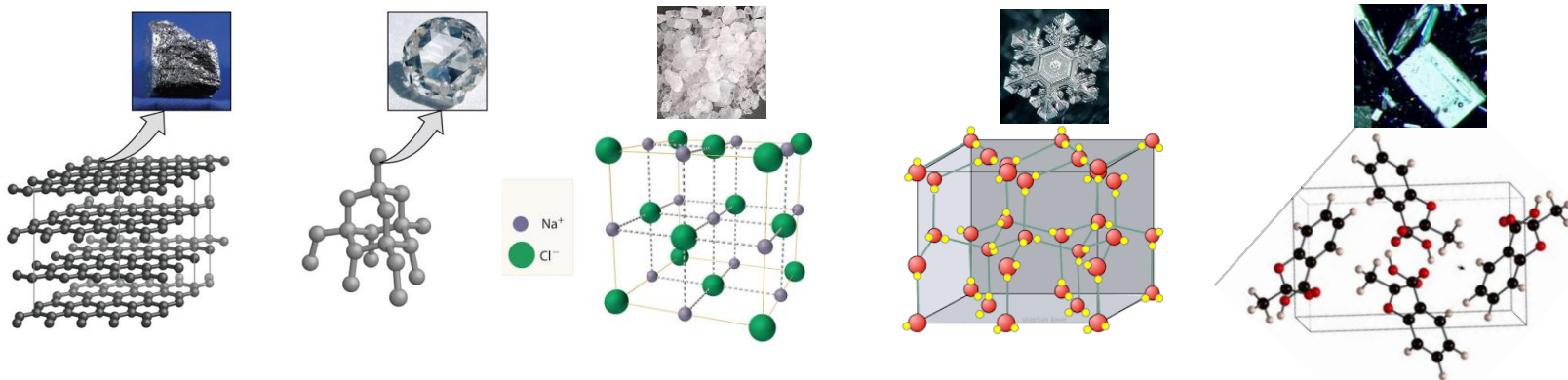
– operations in CE –

- Determination of crystal structures
- Understanding or analysis of crystal structures
- Use of understanding in trying to design a crystal structure
- Actual crystallization experiment
- Realization of pre-desired crystal property

What is a molecular crystal?

Molecular crystal is a **collection of molecules**, held **internally** by rather **strong chemical bonds** and **associated** with each other by **weaker intermolecular interactions**.

- molecular crystal is a crystalline form of any chemical substance that exists as molecule!



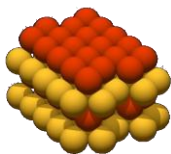
Fundamental questions of modern CE:

Given a molecular structure of a compound, what is its crystal structure?
How does crystalline structure correlate to the properties of the materials?

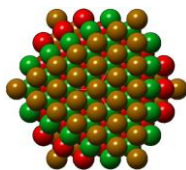
for aggregation phenomena of molecules

Close packing principle

molecules pack in a crystal so that any molecule is surrounded by a maximum number of close neighbors, generally 12.



(hcp)



(ccp)

- minimization of the potential energy of the system
- isotropic attractive and repulsive forces between molecules
- highest possible number of stabilizing interactions



M.C. Escher's "Horsemen"

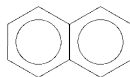
Understanding tools: close packing

Condensed aromatic hydrocarbons C_mH_n

naphthalene

$C_{10}H_8$

$m/n < 1.5$

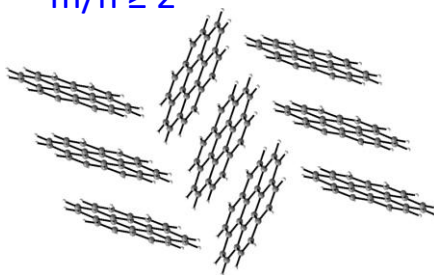


- hydrogen rich molecules
- angle $\sim 40-50^\circ$
- herringbone geometry
- C-H $\cdots\pi$ interactions

coronene

$C_{24}H_{12}$

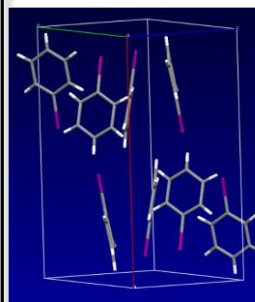
$m/n \geq 2$



- carbon rich molecules ($m/n \geq 2$)
- angle $\sim 90^\circ$
- tendency toward $\pi\cdots\pi$ stacking

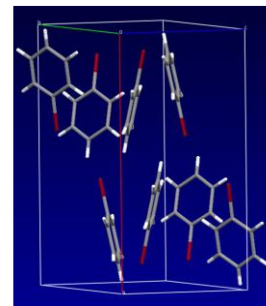
Further crystal packing similarity

I- and Br-derivatives – often „same“ packing



iodobenzene

$a=15.270 \text{ \AA}$
 $b=11.071 \text{ \AA}$
 $c= 7.703 \text{ \AA}$
Pbcn



bromobenzene

$a=14.264 \text{ \AA}$
 $b=11.415 \text{ \AA}$
 $c= 7.501 \text{ \AA}$
Pbcn

- „same“ packing
- same arrangement on molecules
- same cell parameters

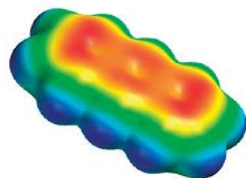
➤ C/H-stoichiometry is a critical parameter

➤ Isostructural compounds

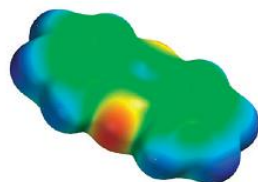
Understanding tools: beyond close packing

Acenes vs N-Heteroacenes: The Effect of N-Substitution on the Structural Features of Crystals of Polycyclic Aromatic Hydrocarbons

Kenneth E. Maly



anthracene



phenazine

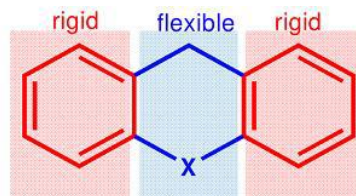
calculated electrostatic potential map

blue – positive, red - negative

- importance of C $\cdots$ H contacts is reduced
- C-H $\cdots$ N interactions in phenazine
- increased tendency to $\pi\cdots\pi$ stacking

➤ Heteroatom impact on crystal packing

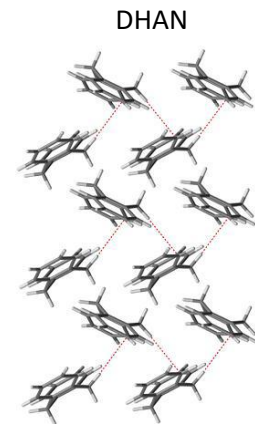
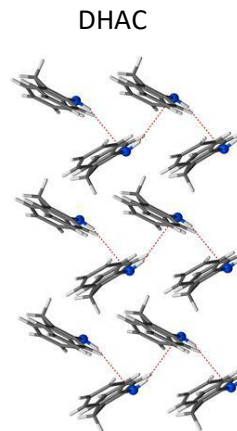
Similarity as exception



X = CH₂, NH

X = CH₂, dihydroanthracene (DHAN)

X = NH, dihydroacridine (DHAC)



- no significant impact of N-H group
- herringbone geometry
- similar C-H $\cdots$ π and N-H $\cdots$ π interactions
- isostructural compounds

➤ Protonation and absence of strong acceptors

for aggregation phenomena of molecules

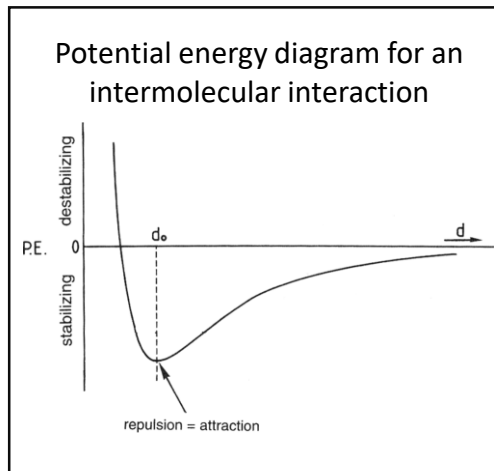
Intermolecular interactions

(between 2 atoms) $\leq \sum$ of their van der Waals radii.

Strength > **weak and strong**
stabilizing & destabilizing **energies**

Distance > **electrostatic** and dispersive

Directionality > isotropic and anisotropic



d_0 - **equilibrium distance**

→ lowest energy

→ repulsion = attraction

distances $d > d_0$ (and some shorter)

→ stabilizing $E < 0$

→ attractive forces

very short distances $d < d_0$

→ destabilizing $E > 0$

→ repulsive forces

stabilizing & destabilizing energies describe intermolecular interactions

Properties of intermolecular interactions

- Strength
short/long & weak/strong
distance & energy

Bond/ Interaction	Bond length (Å)
C-H	
C-C	
C=C	
C≡C	
C-O	
C=O	
O-H	
N-H	
O··H	

Bond/ Interaction	Bond energy (kJ/mol)
O-H	
C-H	
C-C	
C-N	
S-S	
Hydrogen bond	
Van der Waals (vdW)	~

➤ Strength
short/long & weak/strong
distance & energy

- majority of covalent bonds: 300 - 500 kJ/mol
- majority of hydrogen bonds: 4 - 60 kJ/mol

Many interactions important in context of crystal packing are 2-20 kJ/mol
→ energetically very weak!

- Intermolecular interaction: Distance < $\sum$ vdw radii

- **Strength**
 - weak and strong**
 - majority of covalent bonds: 300 - 500 kJ/mol
 - majority of hydrogen bonds: 4 - 60 kJ/mol

- **Directionality**
 - isotropic and anisotropic**

isotropic interactions

non-directional

simple level of molecular recognition

- responsible for supramolecular arrangements
- close packing of the molecules
- include vdW → vdW forces: attractive or repulsive (between all atoms and molecules)

anisotropic interactions

directional

higher level of molecular recognition (lock-and-key principle)

- determine intermolecular orientation and functions
- involve partially charged atoms (N, O, Cl, P, S)
- have electrostatic character – dipole-dipole interaction
- master key – hydrogen bond – fits to different locks

Some important intermolecular interactions in CE

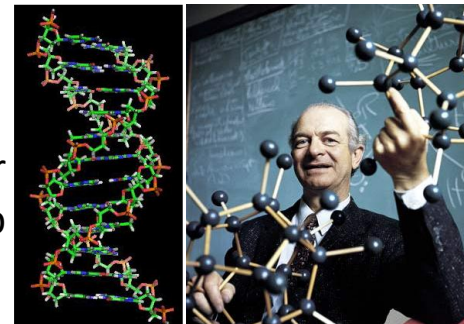
- hydrogen bonds (HB)
- halogen bonding (XB)
- $\pi \cdots \pi$ interactions (stacking)

Definition, importance & properties of H-bonds

Master key of molecular recognition, “the” toolkit of CE

An **attractive interaction** $D-H\cdots A-Z$ between a hydrogen atom from molecular fragment $D-H$ in which D is more electronegative than H , and an atom / group of atoms in the same or a different molecule. *Current IUPAC definition (2011)*

H is more electropositive than D (hydrogen bond donor) and A (HB acceptor)
→ **electrostatic character**



Linus Pauling



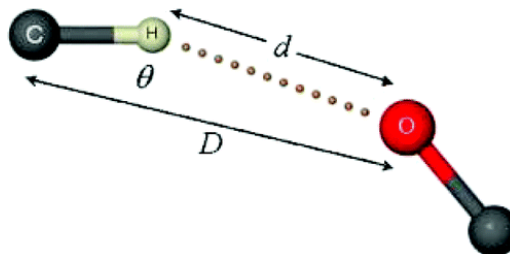
Gautam Desiraju

HB Properties

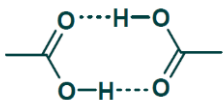
- Strength & length
- Directionality
- Cooperativity
- Hierachy

Hydrogen bond, $X-H\cdots Y-Z$

Strength	Example	$X\cdots Y$ (D , Å)	$H\cdots Y$ (d , Å)	$X-H\cdots Y$ (θ , °)	Bond energy (-kcal/mol)	Effect on crystal packing
very strong $X-H \sim H\cdots Y$	$[F-H-F]^-$	2.2–2.5	1.2–1.5	175–180	15–40	strong
strong $X-H < H\cdots Y$	$O-H\cdots O-H$ $O-H\cdots N-H$ $N-H\cdots O=C$	2.6–3.0 2.6–3.0 2.8–3.0	1.6–2.2 1.7–2.3 1.8–2.3	145–180 150–180 150–180	4–15	distinctive
weak $X-H \ll H\cdots Y$	$C-H\cdots O$ $O-H\cdots \pi$	3.0–4.0	2.0–3.0	110–180 90–180	< 4	variable



O-H...O bonds in carboxylic acid dimers



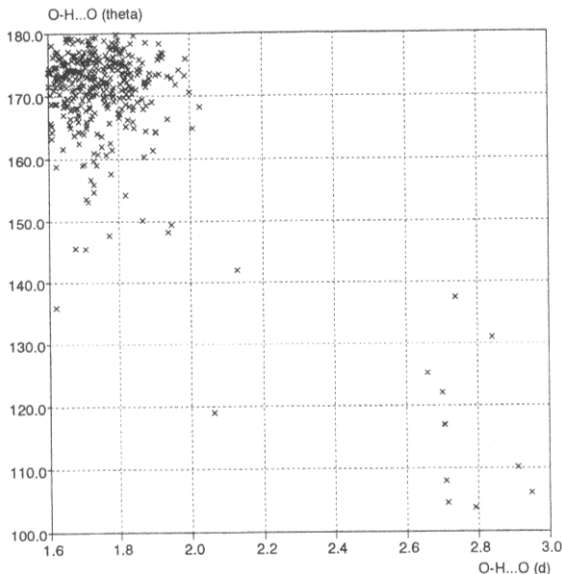
strong HBs

- angle

O-H...O: 160-180°

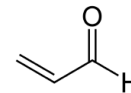
- distance

O...H : 1.6-1.9(2.0)Å



➤ well defined characteristics of strong H-bonds

C-H...O bonds in α,β -unsaturated carbonyl compounds



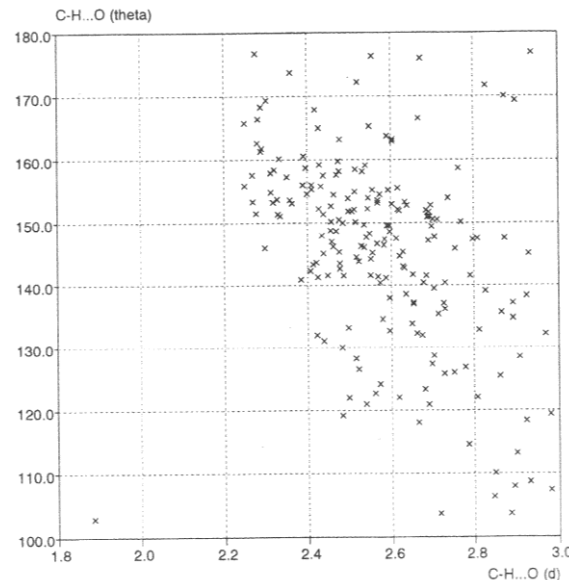
weak HBs

- angle

C-H...O: 100-180°

- Distance

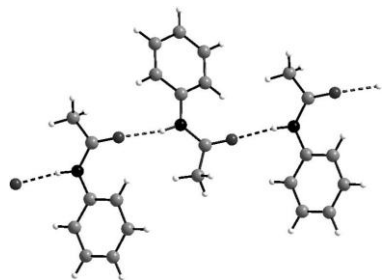
O...H : 2.2-3.0 Å



➤ no information (or defined characteristics) about a general C-H...O H-bond possible

Angular properties of hydrogen bonds

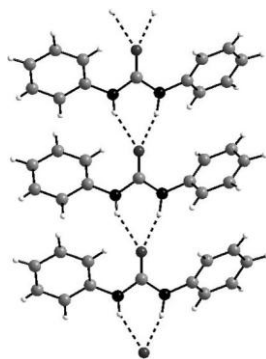
Acetanilide



Linear $\text{N-H}\cdots\text{O}=\text{C}$ bonds connect secondary amide molecules in a one-dimensional array

- chain-like arrangement
- two-centered interaction = “1-Point”HB
- linear angle $\text{D-H}\cdots\text{A} = 180^\circ$

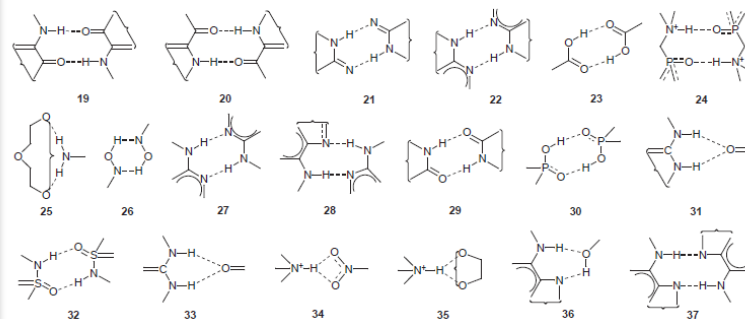
Diphenylurea



A **bifurcated** hydrogen bond, or **three-centered interaction**

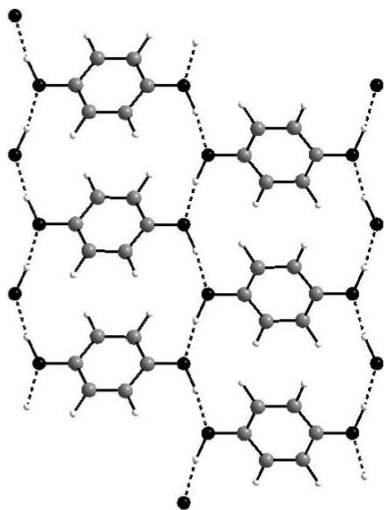
- two equiv. donors, one acceptor
- non linear angle $\text{D-H}\cdots\text{A} < 180^\circ$
- biological systems

Huge variety of hydrogen bonds motifs



e.g. alcohol R-OH (γ -hydroquinone):

acidity of H-atom in $\text{O}-\text{H}\cdots\text{O}-\text{H}$ **dimer** > in an **isolated** O-H group



HBs are more stable when involved in dimers, trimers, chains, infinite 2D- and 3D structures!

Why?

Polarizability & charge transfer effects:

total binding energy of all HB in an aggregate > **energy sum of the individual HBs**

Hierarchy of HBs

HB donors: OH, NH and NH₂

HB acceptors: OH, C=O, NH₂, -N= and -O-

In case of several HB donors and acceptors they pair up along their strength

⇒ the **best H-bond** is formed by the **best H-bond donor** and H-bond **acceptor**

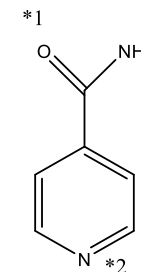
⇒ the **second best HB**: by the **second best HB donor** and the second HB **acceptor**

Experiment:

mix isonicotinamide + two different aromatic acids (1:1:1)

*1:

*2:

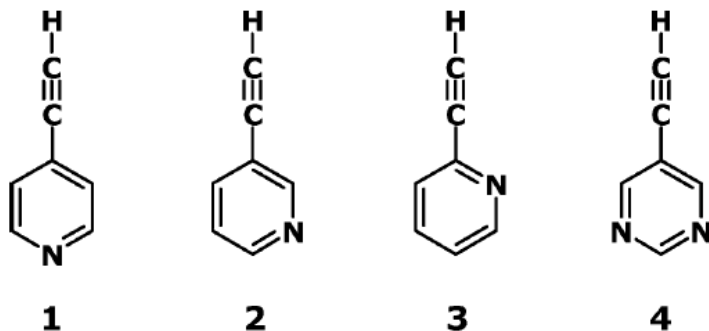


Hierarchy is a characteristic of kinetic (fast) crystallization

Crystal Engineering with $\equiv\text{C}-\text{H}\cdots\text{N}$ and $=\text{C}-\text{H}\cdots\text{N}$ Hydrogen Bonds

Venkat R. Thalladi,^{*,†} Marta Dabros,[†] Annette Gehrke,[‡] Hans-Christoph Weiss,[‡] and Roland Boese^{*,‡}

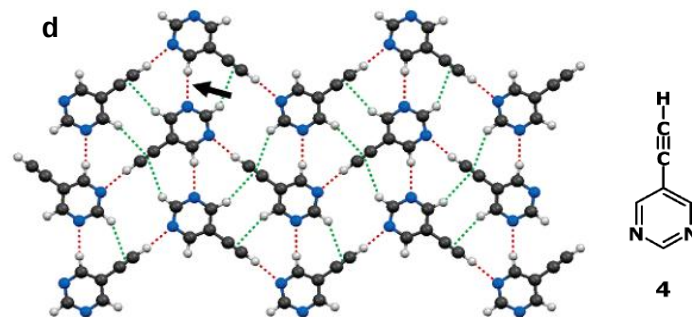
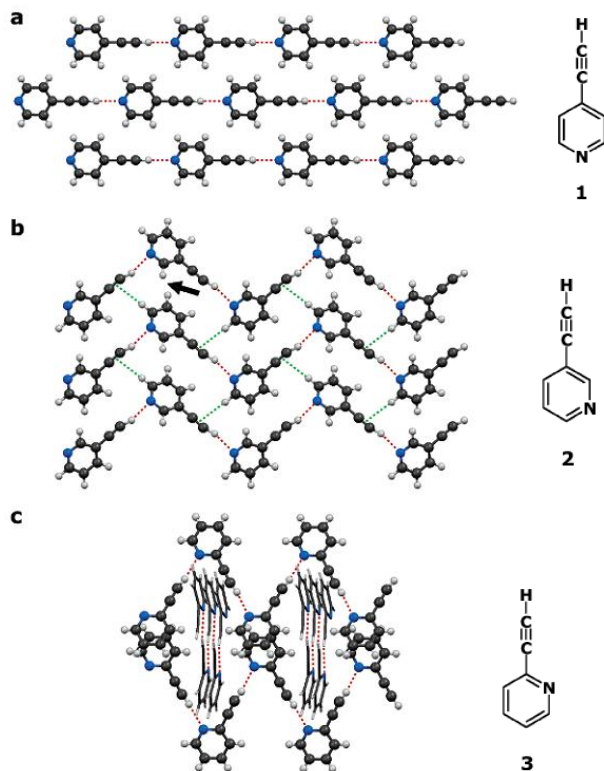
Crystal Growth & Design, Vol. 7, No. 4, 2007



Ethynyl-pyridines and -pyrimidine

- assume that $\equiv\text{C}-\text{H}$ / $=\text{C}-\text{H}$ groups form short & linear hydrogen bonds
- use weak HBs to generate networks with predictable topologies

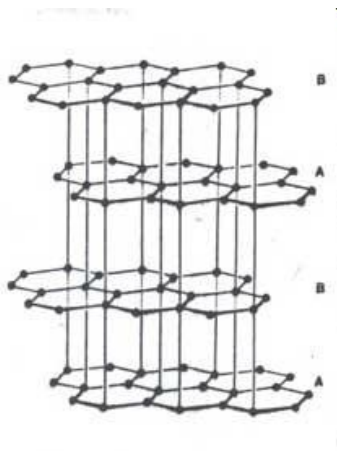
Crystal Engineering with weak $\equiv\text{C-H}\cdots\text{N}$ HBs



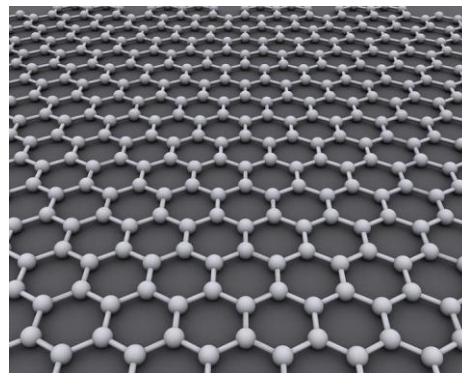
- straight (**1**) and zigzag (**2,3,4**) chain patterns formed by $\equiv\text{C-H}\cdots\text{N}$ hydrogen bonds
- additional cross-stitching of zigzag chains (**4**) by $=\text{C-H}\cdots\text{N}$ hydrogen bonds
→ 2D network

Modulation of analogues of unknown network

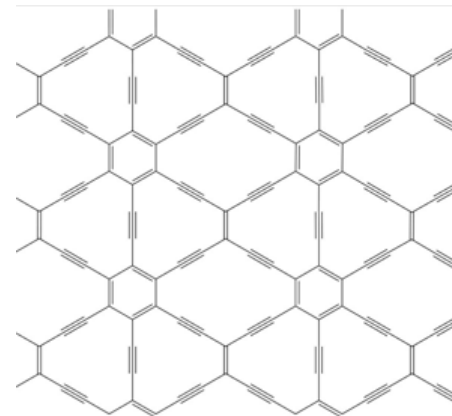
Graphite



Graphene



Graphyne

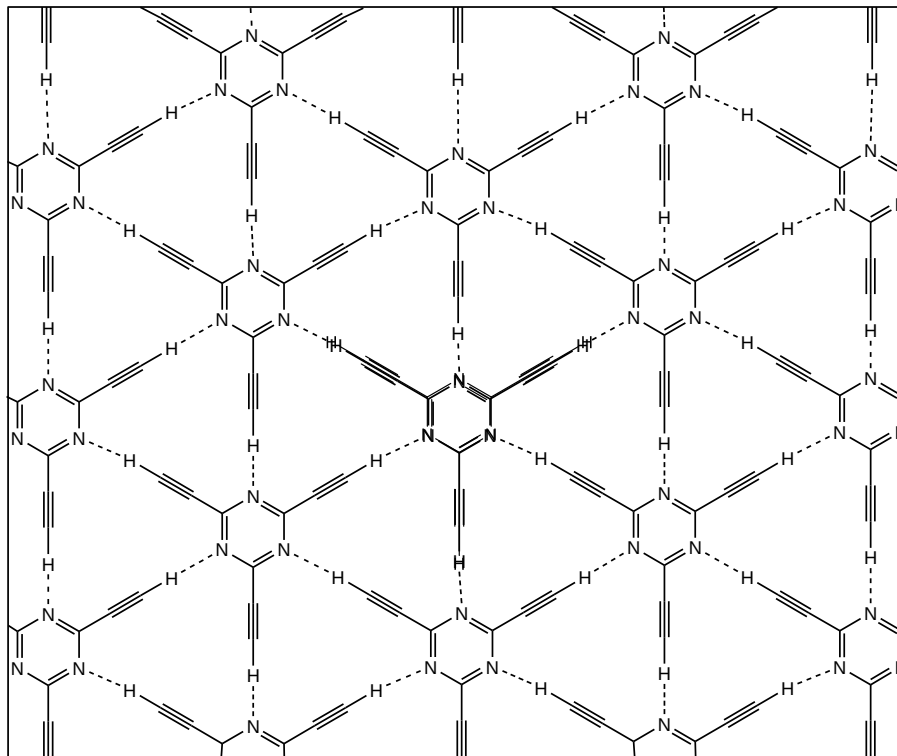


Graphene, a layer of graphite just one atom thick, isn't called a wonder material for nothing. The subject of the 2010 Nobel Prize in physics, it is famed for its superlative mechanical and electronic properties. Yet new computer simulations suggest that the electronic properties of a little-known sister material of graphene—graphyne—may in some ways be better.

The simulations show that graphyne's conduction electrons should travel extremely fast—as they do in graphene—but in only one direction. That property could help researchers design faster transistors and other electronic components that process one-way current, says one of the study's authors, theoretical chemist Andreas Görling of the University of Erlangen-Nuremberg in Germany. "If your material already conducts in one direction, you have a head start," he says.

Supramolecular graphyne:

robust 2D hydrogen-bonded network structure with
suitable model: 2,4,6-triethynyl-1,3,5-triazine



- hexagonal array
- graphyne-like network
- 2D layers
- parallel stacking of layers
- weak C-H...N H-bonds
- $\angle(\text{C-H}\cdots\text{N}) = 180^\circ$
- all N and H atoms involved in the synthon formation

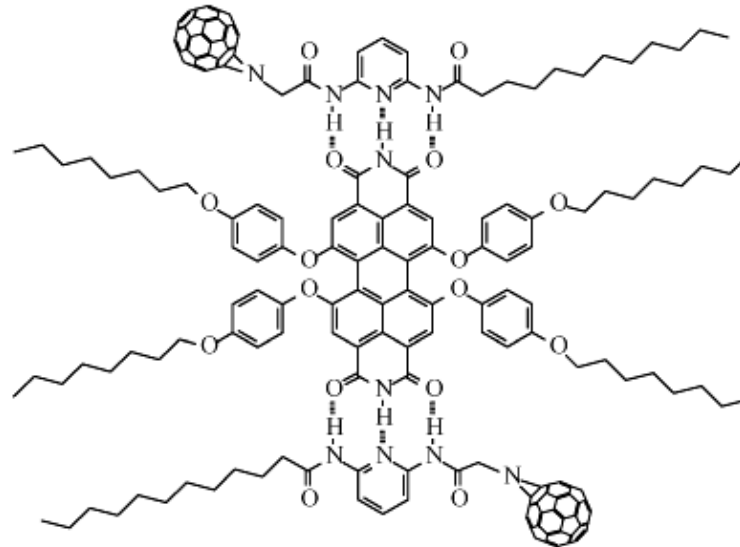
Building blocks for optoelectronic devices

multiple hydrogen bonds for photovoltaic

Superstructure

Self-assembly of C_{60} fullerene derivative with PERY (perylene bisimide)

multiple HBs
DAD sequence



desired construction of functionalised fullerene-based architecture

SCIENTIFIC CONFERENCES

A big hello to halogen bonding

Halogen bonding connects a wide range of subjects — from materials science to structural biology, from computation to crystal engineering, and from synthesis to spectroscopy. The 1st International Symposium on Halogen Bonding explored the state of the art in this fast-growing field of research.

Mate Erdelvi

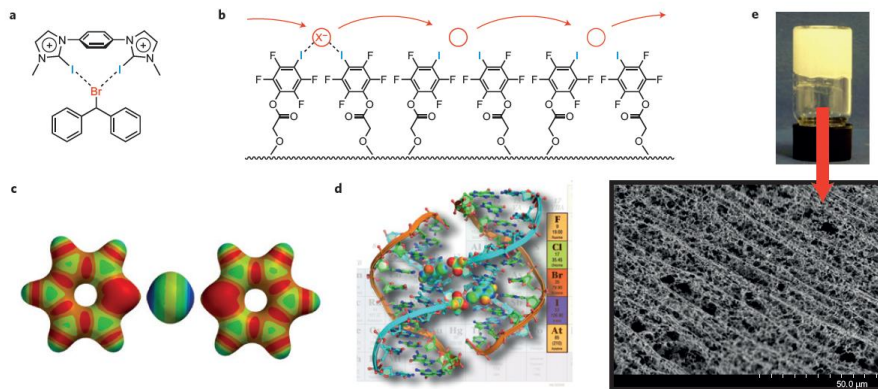
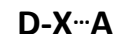


Figure 1 | Some highlights from the ISXB-1 meeting. **a**, A bidentate cationic halogen-bond donor designed for promoting halogen abstraction, for example in the solvolysis of benzhydryl bromide. **b**, A synthetic ion channel that operates with halogen bonds. **c**, An iodonium ion is capable of forming two halogen bonds simultaneously, shown in the example of [bis(pyridine)iodine]⁺. **d**, A DNA junction is an optimal model system to study biomolecular halogen bonds. **e**, An equimolar mixture of bis(pyridyl) urea and diiodotetrafluorobenzene in methanol-water forms a robust hydrogel upon rapid cooling. (Pui Shing Ho and Pierangelo Metrangolo are kindly acknowledged for providing figure parts **d** and **e**, respectively).

IUPAC Definition

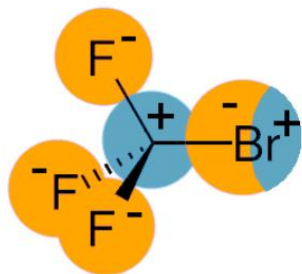
*“A **halogen bond** occurs when there is evidence of a net **attractive interaction** between an **electrophilic region** associated with a **halogen atom** in a molecular entity and a **nucleophilic region** in another, or the same, **molecular entity**”*



(X = I, Br, Cl)

(A = O, N, S)

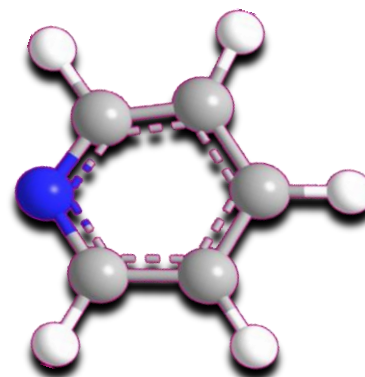
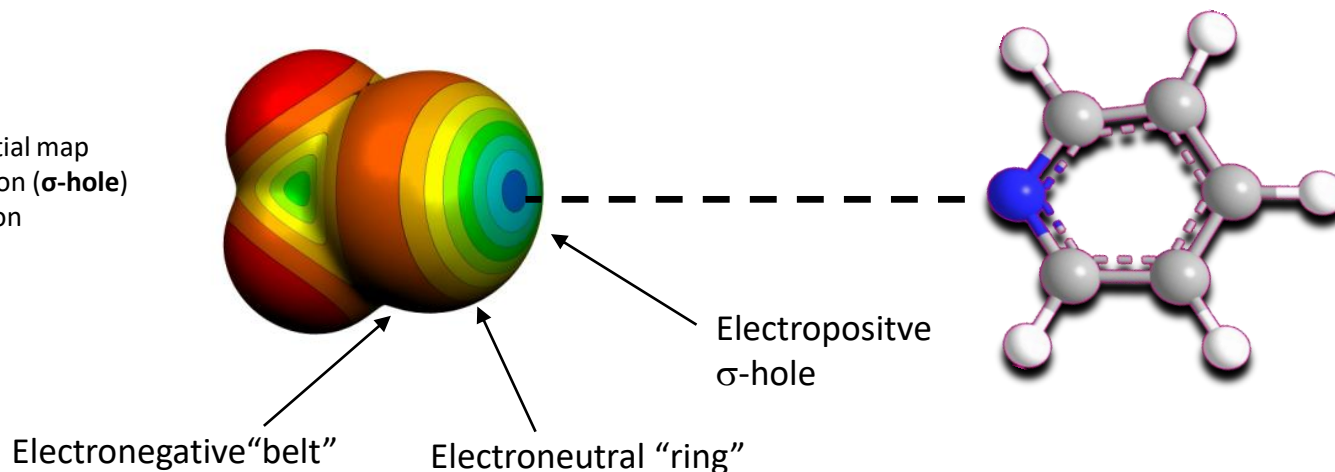
Nature of halogen bond



XB arise from polarization of C-X bond

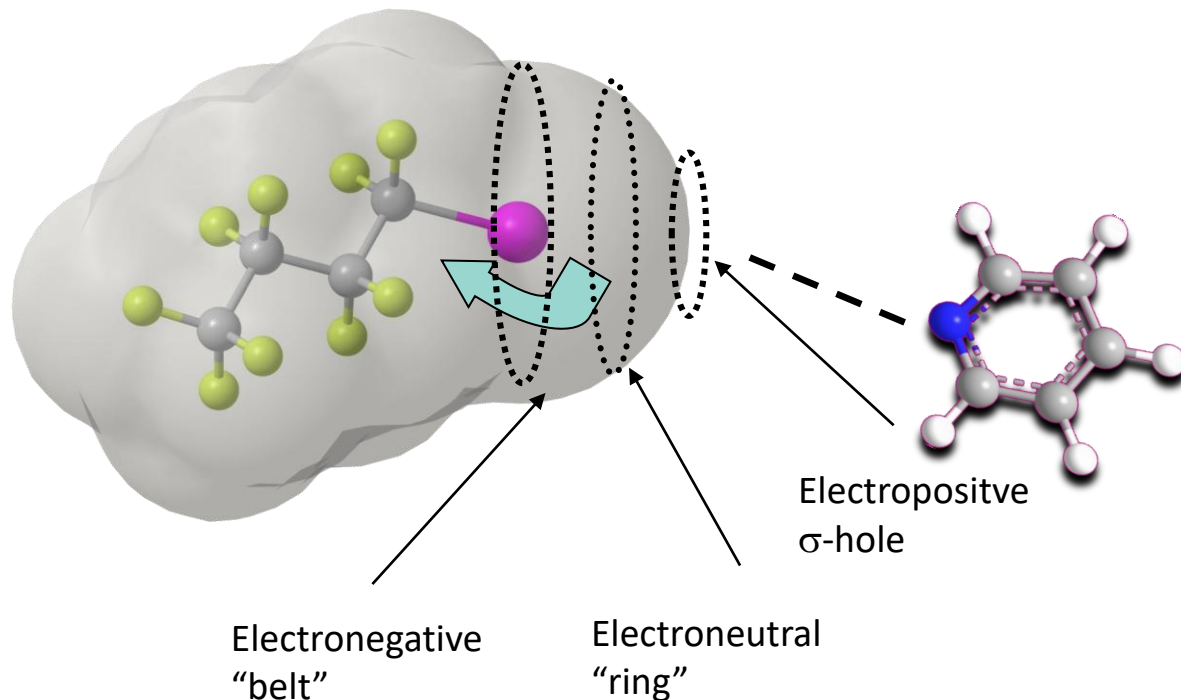
- ⇒ X is polarized positively in the region furthest away from the C atom
- ⇒ polarization gradient on C-X: $C^{\delta+}-X^{\delta-}$
- ⇒ Electrostatic contact with a negatively polarized species
- ⇒ Bond distance shorter than sum of VdW Radii
- ⇒ C-I...N angle approximately 180°

Electrostatic potential map
blue – positive region (σ -hole)
red – negative region



The σ -hole in halogen bonding

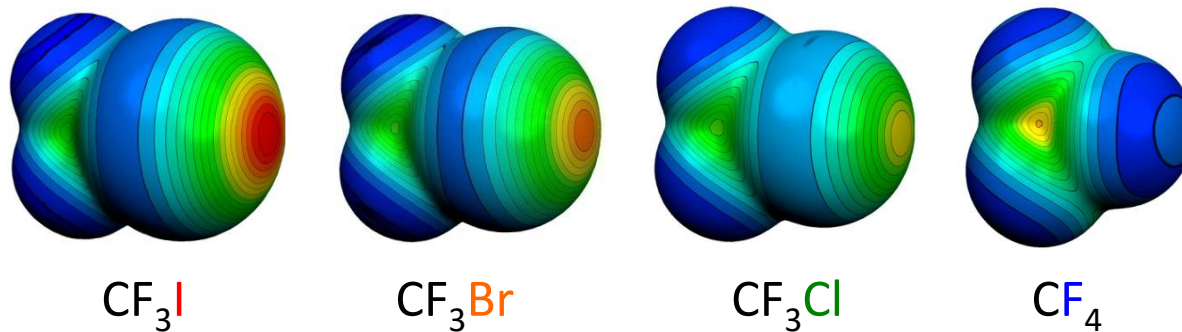
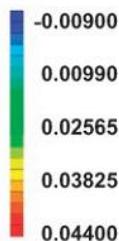
Perfluorination: enlarges the σ -hole $\Rightarrow$ interaction strength increases



- Polarization of C-X bond
 $\Rightarrow$ **Electrostatic** contact with a negatively polarized species
- Bond distance shorter than sum of VdW Radii
- C-I...N angle approximately 180°

The σ -hole dependence of halogen atom

Perfluorination: enlarges σ -hole $\Rightarrow$ interaction strength increases



Electrostatic potentials:
red – positive crown – σ -hole
blue – negative belt

Molecular electrostatic potential of CX_4 - halotrifluoromethane

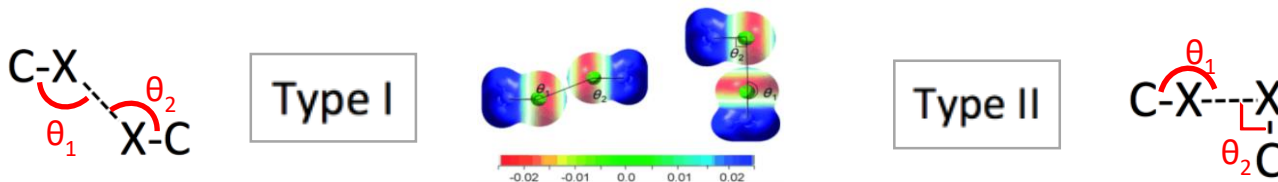
positive region (σ -hole)

- intermolecular interaction strength $\text{I} > \text{Br} \gg \text{Cl} > \text{F}$
- interacts with a N, O, Halogen atom:
 $\text{C-I}\cdots\text{N}$, $\text{C-I}\cdots\text{O}$, $\text{C-Br}\cdots\text{N}$, $\text{C-Br}\cdots\text{N}$

Halogen...halogen interaction and it's geometry

Calculated elektrostatic potentials

- blue – positive polarised,
- red – negatively polarised.



Geometry of two energy minimum of chloromethane

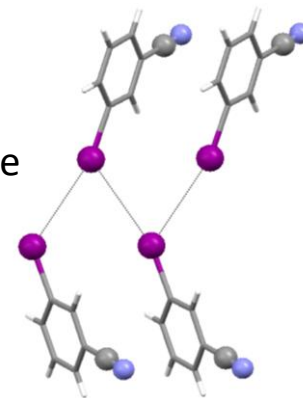
- | | |
|---|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ▪ symmetrical ▪ parallel, electrostatically identical regions ▪ van der Waals type ▪ shortest are actually repulsive ▪ $\theta_1 = \theta_2 \approx 150$ ▪ Torsion angle (C-X...X-C), $\Phi = 180$ | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ▪ genuine X-bond ▪ positive polarisation in the polar region of the halogen atom ▪ a negative polarisation in its equatorial region ▪ $\theta_1 = 180^\circ$ und $\theta_2 = 90^\circ$ |
|---|---|

Properties of XB



Linear arrays in *para*-iodobenzonitrile

meta-iodobenzonitrile
- zig-zag I...I chains



Merz, K., *Crystal Growth & Design*, **2006**, 6, 1615.

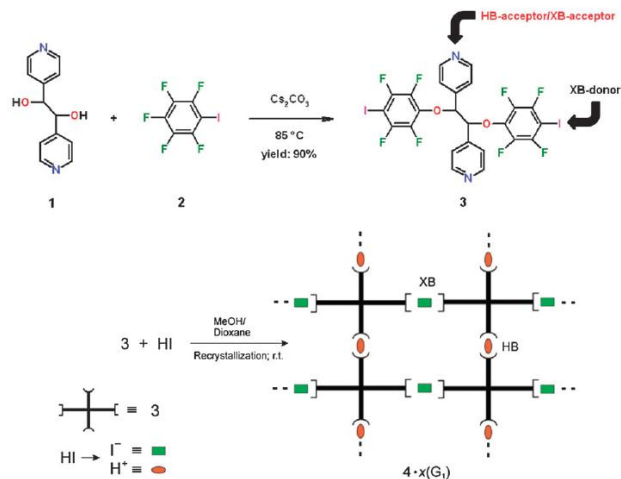
→ Molecular recognition dependant on substitution pattern

XB Properties

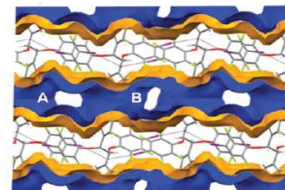
- directional -- σ -hole
- tunable interaction strength -- different depth of the σ -hole
- hydrophobic -- negative and positive sides
- large donor atom size -- tunable: I > Br > Cl

Hydrogen and halogen bonding drive the orthogonal self-assembly of an organic framework possessing 2D channels†

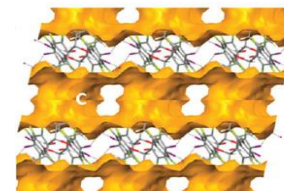
- open framework with 2D channels
- able to host various guest molecules
- single-crystal-to-single-crystal guest exchange



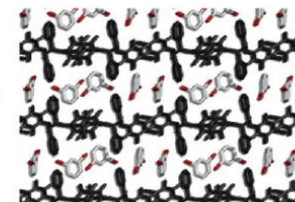
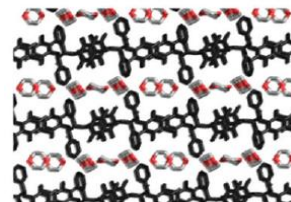
Voids observed after removal of guest molecules.



channels A and B



channel C intersects
A and B channels



single-crystal-to-single-crystal guest exchange

XB a promising new tool for the design of open framework materials
→ pre-stage of non-covalently bonded metal-organic frameworks (MOF)

XB in luminescent materials

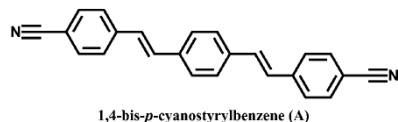
➤ self-assembling organic spin systems

➤ organic solid-state chromophores:

promising optoelectronic applications in the fields of light-emitting diodes, lasers, sensors, and two-photon fluorescent materials.

Challenge: obtain light-emission of an appropriate wavelength

fluorescent molecules **A**



its co-formers **B-G**

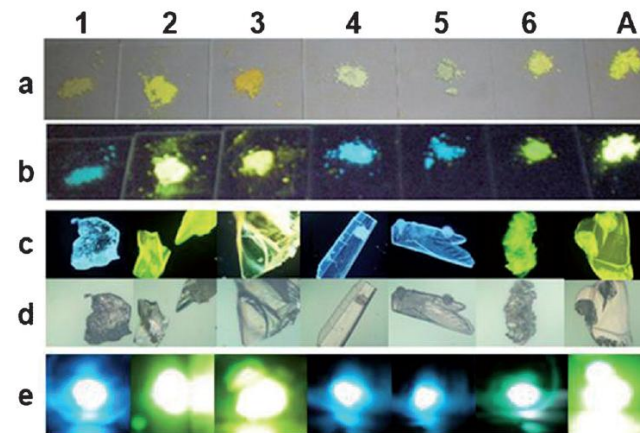
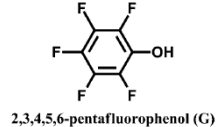
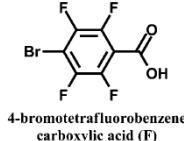
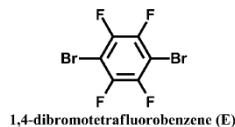
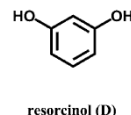
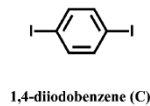
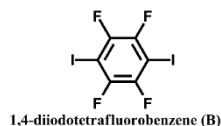


Figure 2. Photographs of solid-state cocrystal samples (from left to right: 1–6) and A. a) and b) the powder samples under daylight and UV (365 nm); c) and d) the single crystal samples under UV (365 nm) and daylight observed by fluorescence microscope multiplied by 50-fold; e) two-photon luminescence under 800 nm laser.

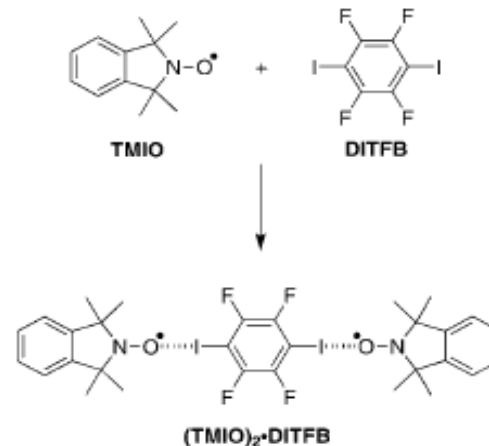
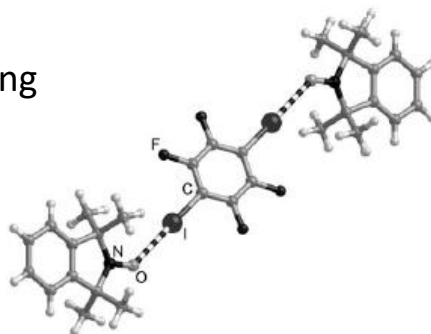
Fine-tuning of UV/VIS absorption, luminescence emission, color, lifetime, quantum yield and structural properties by cocrystal formation

Iodoperfluorocarbons:

→ paramagnetic molecules as building blocks

Potential app.:

- molecular magnetism
- spintronics
- quantum computing



TMIO: tetramethylisoidolinyloxy
DITFB: diiodotetrafluorobenzene

ionic resonance structure of the radical stabilized by N-O...I interaction

XB in fungicides

➤ case study of a preservative

3-Iodo-2-propynyl-*N*-butylcarbamate (**IPBC** / **Iodocarb**):

antimicrobial product used as preservative, fungicide and algaecide.

Problems:

- Difficult to obtain in pure form
- Hard to handle in industrial products and processes
- Sticky and clumpy

Idea:

- co-crystals

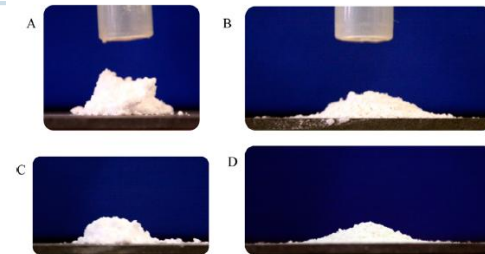
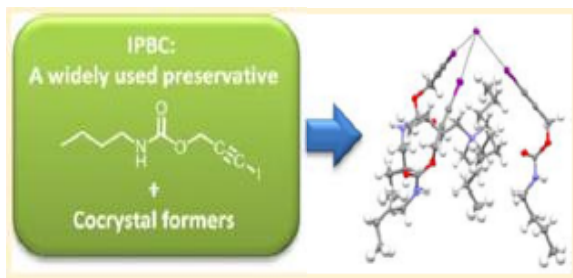
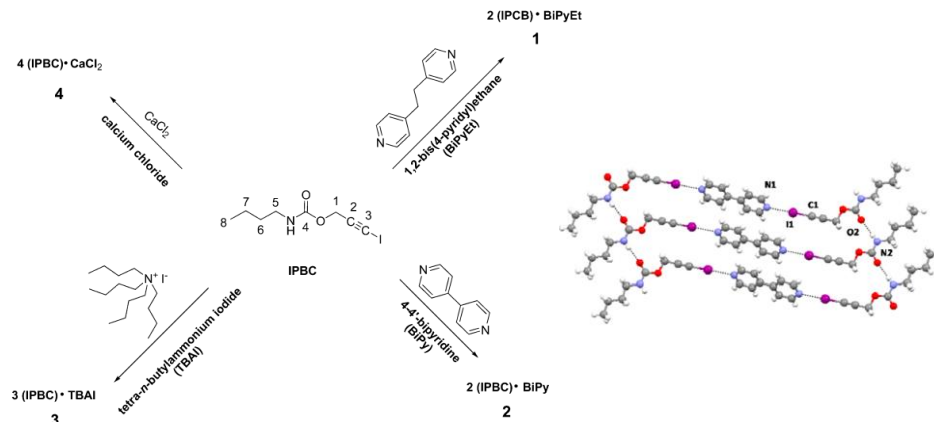


Figure 9. Pictures of cones of IPBC (A, C) and cocrystal 4 (B, D) powders, taken after flowing the powders through the funnel from 25 mm (A, B) and 50 mm (C, D) heights. The cylindrical shape of IPBC cones indicates clearly the high cohesion of the powders, while the flat cone shape of the cocrystal 4 indicates improved powder flow properties.



Fluorine substituent effect

Fluorine substituent effect

1. on physico-chemical properties ?
2. on interactions ?

Special properties of F:

- high electronegativity
- relatively small size
- very low polarisability

Perfluorocarbons

- Nearly ideal liquids.
- High compressibility.
- High vapor pressures.
- Poor solvents for organics.
 - non-polar molecules;
 - low polarizability;
 - small inter- and intra-molecular forces.

Hydrofluorocarbons

- Polar molecules.
- Appreciable inter- and intra-molecular interactions

on physico-chemical properties of **fluorocarbons**:
only some tendencies

- Solubility (the least and the most polar solvents)
- Lipophilicity (increases in aromatic systems)
- Inductive effect (electron withdrawing)
- Acidity and basicity (increases HB acidity, decreases basicity)
- Steric effect (depends on compound and fluorination pattern)

Fluorine substituent effect

On interactions?

Fluorine: no σ -hole $\rightarrow$ no XB formation

What about HB?

F atom should be a stronger H-bond-acceptor than O or N

- correct for HF_2^-
- not correct for organic fluorinated compounds (C-F)

Table 1. Calculated hydrogen bond energies (kcal mol^{-1}) in some gas-phase dimers.^[a]

Dimer	Energy
$[\text{F}-\text{H}-\text{F}]^-$	39
$[\text{H}_2\text{O}-\text{H}-\text{OH}_2]^+$	33
$[\text{H}_3\text{N}-\text{H}-\text{NH}_3]^+$	24
$[\text{HO}-\text{H}-\text{OH}]^-$	23
$\text{NH}_4^+ \cdots \text{OH}_2$	19
$\text{NH}_4^+ \cdots \text{Bz}$	17
$\text{HOH} \cdots \text{Cl}^-$	13.5
$\text{O}=\text{C}-\text{OH} \cdots \text{O}=\text{C}-\text{OH}$	7.4
$\text{HOH} \cdots \text{OH}_2$	4.7; 5.0
$\text{N}\equiv\text{C}-\text{H} \cdots \text{OH}_2$	3.8
$\text{HOH} \cdots \text{Bz}$	3.2
$\text{F}_3\text{C}-\text{H} \cdots \text{OH}_2$	3.1
$\text{Me}-\text{OH} \cdots \text{Bz}$	2.8
$\text{F}_2\text{HC}-\text{H} \cdots \text{OH}_2$	2.1; 2.5
$\text{NH}_3 \cdots \text{Bz}$	2.2
$\text{HC}\equiv\text{CH} \cdots \text{OH}_2$	2.2
$\text{CH}_4 \cdots \text{Bz}$	1.4
$\text{FH}_2\text{C}-\text{H} \cdots \text{OH}_2$	1.3
$\text{HC}\equiv\text{CH} \cdots \text{C}\equiv\text{CH}^-$	1.2
$\text{HSH} \cdots \text{SH}_2$	1.1
$\text{H}_2\text{C}=\text{CH}_2 \cdots \text{OH}_2$	1.0
$\text{CH}_4 \cdots \text{OH}_2$	0.3; 0.5; 0.6; 0.8
$\text{C}=\text{CH}_2 \cdots \text{C}\equiv\text{C}$	0.5
$\text{CH}_4 \cdots \text{F}-\text{CH}_3$	0.2

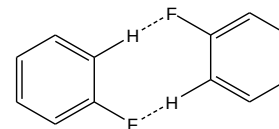
On Interactions?

- **C-H...F** interactions similar to C-H...O and C-H...N, but **very weak**
- C-H...F well established but pretty unpredictable, **system dependent**

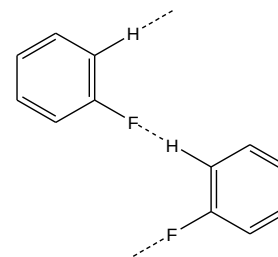
and still...

Classification of packing motifs with C-F...H interactions

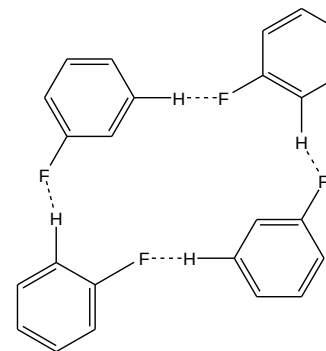
C-H...F comparable to C-H...N hydrogen bonds
➤ stabilizing specific crystal structures



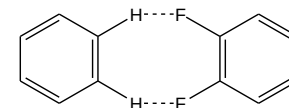
I



II



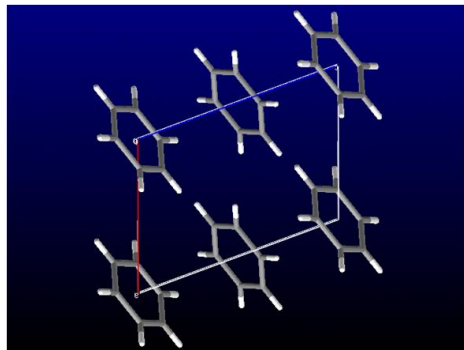
III



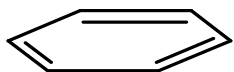
IV

Crystal packing of benzene

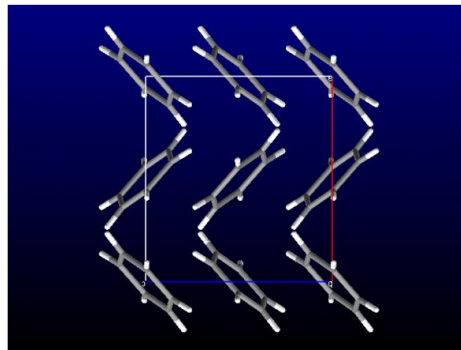
➤ isostructural to fluorobenzene C_6F_6



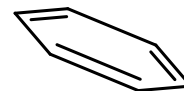
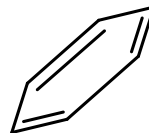
high pressure modification



face-to-face $\pi \cdots \pi$ stacking

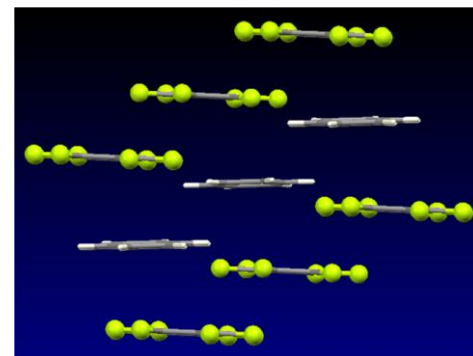
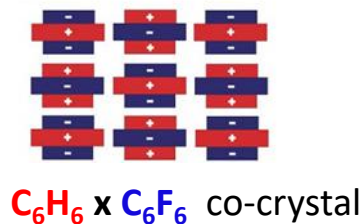
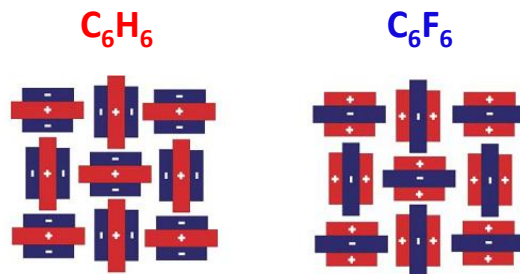
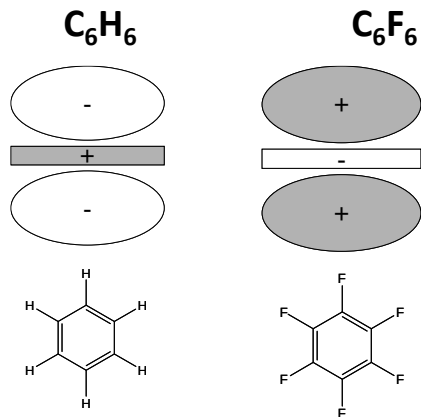


modification at 1 atm



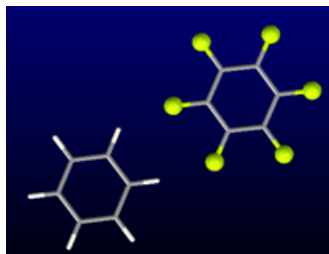
edge-to-face $C-H \cdots \pi$ interaction

Quadrupole moments:



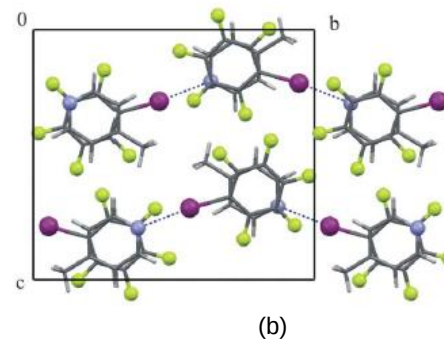
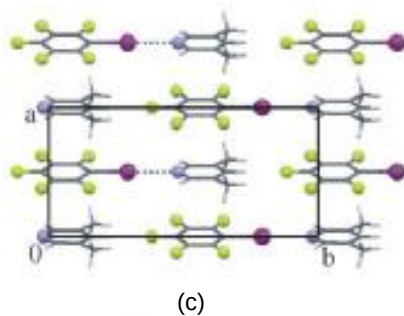
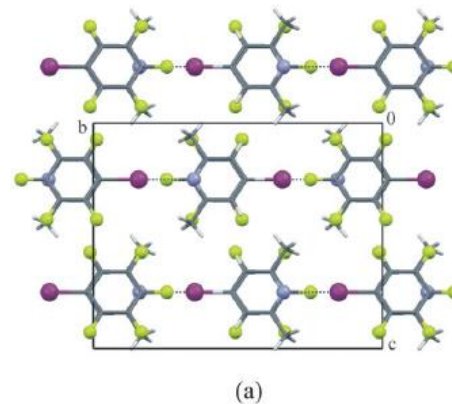
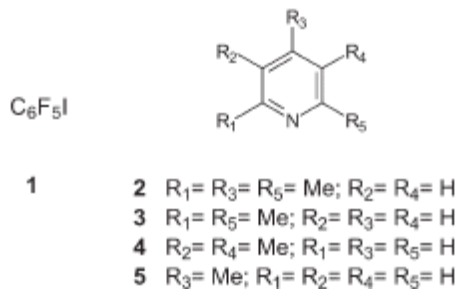
$\pi \cdots \pi$ stacking

→ aryl-perfluoroaryl interaction



Aryl-perfluoroaryl interactions in CE co-crystal formation

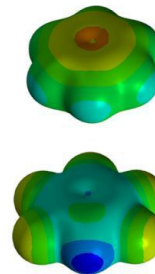
➤ XB + aryl-perfluoroaryl stacking



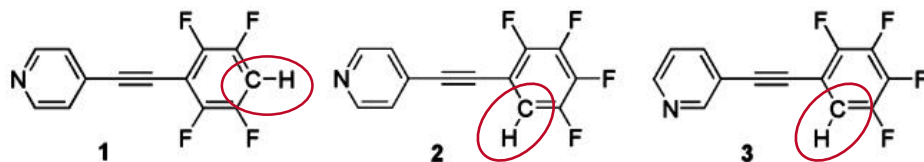
Aryl-perfluoroaryl interactions in CE

- HB + aryl-perfluoroaryl stacking
- weak C-H...N HBs in F-substituted phenylethynylpyridines

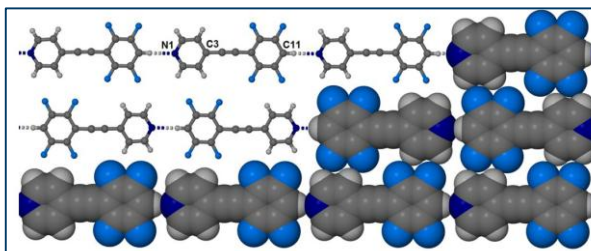
Electrostatic potential map of C_6H_6 and C_6HF_5



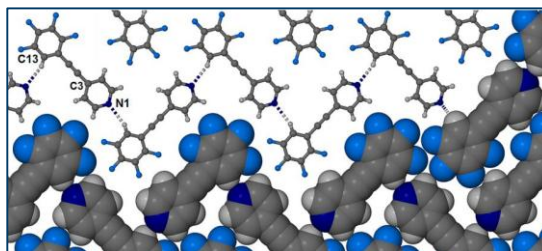
blue – positive charge



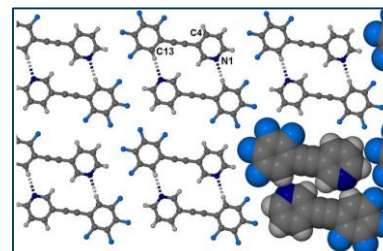
→ Increased acidity of phenyl proton by fluorination of the benzene ring



1: linear chains



2: zig-zag chains



3: dimers

Fluorine applications in coatings and theranostics

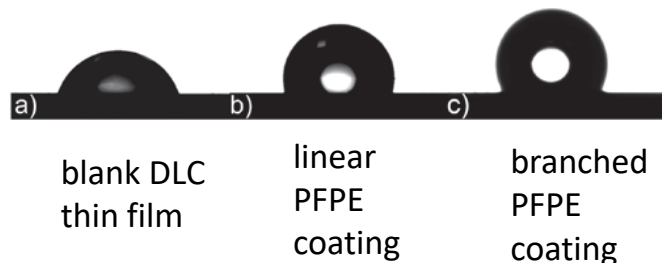
Linear and branched perfluoropolyether coatings on diamond-like carbon films: covalent linkage and physical deposition

WALTER NAVARRINI¹, MAURIZIO SANSOTERA^{1*}, FRANCESCO VENTURINI², CLAUDIA L. BIANCHI³, ANTONIO GUARDIA³, GIUSEPPE RESNATI¹

Application of liquid lubricant films on diamond-like carbon (DLC) coatings.

Hard surfaces are typically lubricated with perfluoropolyethers (PFPE).

Water droplets on several DLC coatings

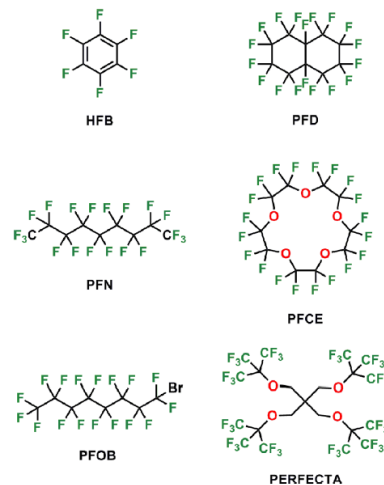


CHEMICAL REVIEWS

Review
pubs.acs.org/CR

¹⁹F Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI): From Design of Materials to Clinical Applications

Ilaria Tirotta,^{†,‡} Valentina Dichiarante,^{†,‡} Claudia Pigliacelli,^{†,‡} Gabriella Cavallo,^{†,‡} Giancarlo Terraneo,^{†,‡} Francesca Baldelli Bombelli,^{*,†,‡,§} Pierangelo Metrangola,^{*,†,‡,||} and Giuseppe Resnati^{*,†,‡}



¹⁹F probe

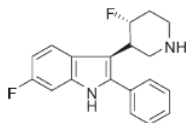
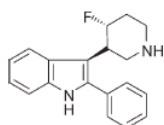
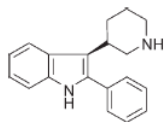
¹⁹F MRI

Theranostics

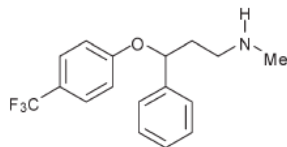
Therapeutic

Polyfluorocarbons
as **MRI tracers**:
molecular tracers, polymers,
branched derivatives

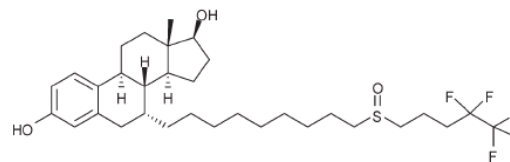
Fluorine in medicinal chemistry



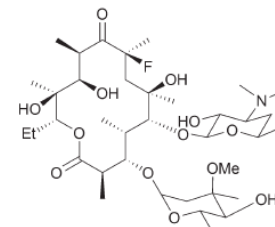
3-piperidinyndole
antipsychotic drugs



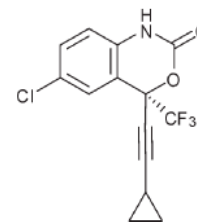
Prozac®
antidepressant



Faslodex®
oestrogen receptor antagonist



Flurithromycin
antibiotic



Efavirenz
transcriptase inhibitor HIV treatment

In a series of 3-piperidinyndole: fluorination decreased the basicity of the amine, thereby improving bioavailability